The event loop is the wrong place to do heavy processing. You can get away with sorting 15,000 competitors if you do it efficiently and infrequently, but you won't get away with sorting millions of competitors. A program on the event loop must respond quickly to incoming events. If it spends all the time processing things, that defeats the purpose. Besides, some things aren't just large—they're infinite.

9.2.2. Infinite time

How do you deal with a data source that never ends? Think about how you kept track of the most popular pages on a website in chapter 3. You didn't try to load all of the data; after all, that would be impossible because the data never finishes. Trying to load it all at once is effectively the same as doing this:

```
loop 0
```

Not desirable. In figure 9.3 you can see Agtron and Scruffy play out what might happen if Agtron ran on an event loop.

Figure 9.3. Don't block the event loop—unless you like to wait.